

Data Dictionary

This data dictionary describes the variables included in the dataset accompanying “A dataset of article processing charges from 14 scholarly publishers, 2019–2025” by Matthias et al. (2026) and “Estimating global article processing charges paid to 14 publishers for open access between 2019 and 2025” by Matthias et al. (2026). The dataset documents:

Variable name	Description	Example value
record_id	Unique ID per record.	9580
unique_id	Unique ID per journal.	1782
publisher	The publisher of the journal in the particular year.	Elsevier
issn_1	The first ISSN of the journal, either print or electronic.	0022-1759
issn_2	The second ISSN of the journal, either print or electronic, if provided.	1872-7905
issn_l	The linking ISSN (ISSN-L) of the journal, if provided.	0022-1759
journal	The proper title of the journal (normalized).	BURNS
oa_status	The open access status of the journal, as indicated by the publisher, journal website, or price list.	Hybrid OA
type_of_fee	The type of fee the article processing charge (APC) represents. Where no fee information could be found, the value is recorded as unknown.	flat rate
apc_currency* <i>* for each of following currencies: USD, EUR, GBP, JPY, CHF, CAD, AUD</i>	The APC value as provided by the publisher or converted into each respective currency.	2,950
apc_currency_originalOR converted	Indicates whether the value came directly from the publisher’s price list or was converted from another currency using an annual conversion rate.	original

apc_text	Additional APC information for entries whose type_of_fee is not a flat rate (e.g., page charges or scaled fees).	300-900 EUR
apc_date	Date of collection of the price list, or of the Wayback Machine snapshot.	2019-06-01
apc_year	Year of the price list, or of the Wayback Machine snapshot.	2019
apc_source	Original source of price list.	Publisher website
collector	Name of person who collected the price list.	N. Schönfelder
comment	Further contextual or significant details.	Journal transferred from Sage to Wiley in 2019
data_version	Version of the dataset release: 1 for records from the first release (Butler et al., 2024), 2 for records added in the second (Matthias et al., 2026).	1
